understand where this sense of optimism comes from given that unlike Bharat vast swathes of the ‘New World’ have turned Christian post the advent of the European coloniser, to err on the side of caution I would adopt a policy of civilisational vigilance for two reasons:

1. Given that the Indian State as well as the colonialised indigenous native are only too happy to wear the secularised Christian framework as a badge of honour, even if Bharat does not convert to Christianity, it would be equally bad or perhaps worse if Indic OET systems are completely Christianised; and
2. Conventional proselytisation has effectively alienated large parts of Bharat from the Indic consciousness and has, in fact, turned a significant cross-section of Bharat against it.

Therefore, I would not draw too much comfort from a mere paper identity when the native Indic consciousness is buried under layers of colonial consciousness without even realising it. As stated earlier, the decolonial ‘option’ is not just an option but an existential imperative for Indic civilisational consciousness; and since the Constitution is being pushed as a ‘secular’ document without examining it for colonial consciousness, a decolonial evaluation of the document and its antecedents is an exercise that must be undertaken without any further protraction. After all, the Constitution is capable of creating a multiplier effect either in favour of Indic consciousness or to its detriment.

Accordingly, in the next and final section of this book, I will examine the period between 1858 and 1919 to understand the influence of the colonial infrastructure in Bharat as well as that of international developments on Bharat’s gradual movement towards a constitutional framework. One of the reasons for choosing the time frame from 1858 is because it is typically assumed that the so-called policy of Christian toleration morphed into a policy of irreligious secularism, thanks to the landmark events of 1857. Among other things, this assumption too will be put to test in the next section.